One of the things I remember asking him was how he thought he would have coped in the contemporary game. He said that he didn't think he would have scored quite so many runs because of the more defensive field settings that are used nowadays; when he was playing, the fields weren't changed much, even if a batsman was scoring a lot of runs, and fielding positions like deep point weren't in vogue back in the 1930s. He also said that the standard of fielding was much better in the contemporary game.

Finally, we asked what he thought his Test average would be if he played today. 'Around 70,' he said. We were slightly surprised and asked if he was sure it would be so much lower than his famous career average of 99.94. He said, 'Well, 70 isn't bad for a ninety-year-old!'

All in all, 1998 was a special year in my career.

Australia in India 1998 – The Border–Gavaskar Trophy

1st Test. Chennai. 6–10 March 1998

India 257 (NS Sidhu 62, NR Mongia 58, R Dravid 52, **SR Tendulkar 4**; GR Robertson 4–72, SK Warne 4–85) and 418–4 dec (**SR Tendulkar 155***, NS Sidhu 64, M Azharuddin 64, R Dravid 56)

Australia 328 (IA Healy 90, ME Waugh 66, GR Robertson 57; A Kumble 4–103, SLV Raju 3–54) and 168 (SK Warne 35, IA Healy 32*; A Kumble 4–46)

India won by 179 runs

2nd Test. Kolkata. 18–21 March 1998

Australia 233 (SR Waugh 80, RT Ponting 60; SC Ganguly 3–28, A Kumble 3–44, J Srinath 3–80) and 181 (MA Taylor 45; A Kumble 5–62, J Srinath 3–44)

India 633–5 dec (M Azharuddin 163*, NS Sidhu 97, VVS Laxman 95, R Dravid 86, **SR Tendulkar 79**, SC Ganguly 65)

India won by an innings and 219 runs

3rd Test. Bangalore. 25–28 March 1998

India 424 (**SR Tendulkar 177**, NS Sidhu 74, M Azharuddin 40; AC Dale 3–71, SK Warne 3–106) and 169 (NS Sidhu 44, **SR Tendulkar 31**; MS Kasprowicz 5–28, GR Robertson 3–28, SK Warne 2–80)

Australia 400 (ME Waugh 153*, MJ Slater 91, DS Lehmann 52; A Kumble 6–98) and 195–2 (MA Taylor 102*, MJ Slater 42; **SR Tendulkar 1–41**)